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# AFRICAN VISION MALAWI

*CREATING LASTING CHANGE*

Issue 31

Newsletter
Winter 2019

Charity no
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Our Vision: A healthy, educated, self-sufficient community in Malawi

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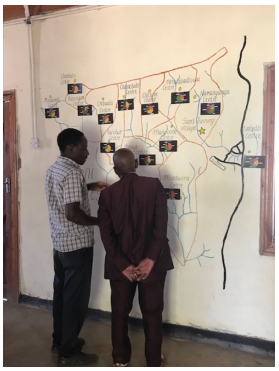

## SAMS TRAINING VILLAGE

**STEP program coming to an end**

Since March 2018, we have done back-to-back vocational training at Sam's Village. It has been amazing to see how the *'STEP program'* (Skills and Technical Education Programme) www.stepmw.com has changed people's lives. We are now able to visit all of the people that have been trained to see how great they are managing their own business. By the end of January 2020 we will have trained 216 people in carpentry, tailoring, basic electronics, solar installation, tinsmithing, motorbike maintenance, bicycle repairs and baking! This has truly been life-changing to these people who are HIV+, disabled, single parents or young adult orphans.



*The bread oven built for the baking course*



*A mural illustrating our 400km² support area*



*Rammed Earth trainees*



*A Tinsmithing graduate*

## Creating Lasting Change

We managed to fund our first course of Tailoring training in March 2018, through funds from St Mary Magdalene Church in Warwick. Now with the added STEP courses, we are getting positive stories from people who are now set up in business.



*Recent graduates from the STEP program*



*Charity Kaunda (left) is a single mother of 4 who trained with us in Carpentry. Before the course she was earning £6 a month selling tomatoes. She moved to mustard farming and started to earn £20 a month and could finally afford to begin her carpentry business. In June she sold 3 stools for £35! She can now pay school fees for her children and continue growing her business.*



*Wesley Kingsley (right) has difficulty with his right leg, and was farming for around £3 a month before doing a basic electronics course at Sam's Village. In July alone he earned £75! He did this through running an electronic repair shop with his friends, often seeing up to 15 customers a day. He even has solar power in his home!*



*Alex Frackson (left with friend) was farming, earning only £50 a year. He has now managed to earn over £200 from his Tailoring business alone since his course last year. He has also managed to buy 4 pigs and 6 chickens from his proceeds and his life has changed for the better.*



*Two children with cerebral palsy receive wheelchairs from 'Motivation'*



*Zozo now at home at Sam's Village*





*Mphatso Simon had never walked until 500 Miles provided her with prosthetic legs!*

## HEALTH

We have 785 people on our Disability register of which 435 have been treated by *'500 Miles'* with prosthetics and orthotic supports. Getting these devices can totally change their lives and help them be independent. Mphatso had never walked before getting her new legs!

*'Motivation'* have donated wheelchairs to us and two children with cerebral palsy were so happy to get their incredible, durable wheelchairs. Their parents carried them on their backs to receive the chairs, so this is going to make such a difference to all of their lives.

Our grateful thanks to *'Project4Africa'* who have funded maintenance at our Maternity Unit and helped make it a safe environment to give birth in. Maggie Martin kindly donated funds to replace all the 10 beds!





*Thanks to Project4Africa and to Maggie Martin for supporting the Maternity Unit*

## STAFF

We have a new receptionist joining us at Sam's village. Welcome to the team Cecilia Chawinga (below left)!

We have also appointed Stanley Msukunika (right) to be our new M&E Officer. Congratulations!





*AVM volunteer meal*

Thanks to all our volunteers in the UK who give their time tirelessly to helping organise fundraisers, write proposals, support admin and we occasionally have a meal out to thank each other! Eileen Speak, Gaynor Cook, Lorraine Mole, Sarah Parsloe, Tina Walker, Tracey O'Shea to name a few!

We were very happy to celebrate Gaynor Cook's (Founder) amazing 80th whilst in Malawi. She is still incredibly enthusiastic and committed to supporting the work of AVM and we thank her for all that she has done over the past 14 years. (birthday cake below!)



*The lovely couple*

Congratulations to Eric Munthali, our Finance and Operations Manager, who married Eve on 5th October. It was a beautiful wedding reflected by the stunning couple!

Our staff of the month in July was Cecilia Chiwinga (below); August we had Walter Malikesi ; in September we had Bisweck Chipwaila (middle); October both Atupele Mkulichi and Haswell Samson and November was awarded to both Peter and Aziel Pemba. All these people are voted for by our Management team for their good work and attitude throughout the month.







## EDUCATION

Our ongoing thanks to '*Project4Africa*' who continue to support Namanyanga Primary School and the Maternity with maintenance work. They have recently funded building a new Staff room and Heads office which is welcomed by all staff.

Our thanks also goes to '*Feed the Children*' who have been supplying nutritional porridge to feed just under 1,000 children five days a week! 5,000 meals per week which is 20,000 meals every month! Our numbers attending our CBCCs (Community Based Childcare Centres) has increased and the children look healthier and happier!



*Namanyanga staff room and Head teacher's office*









*(Above and right) photos showing happy and healthy children going to the CBCCs*

*Scholarship students*

We have 11 students that were selected to go on our scholarship program in September. We currently have 10 of them sponsored and our thanks go to all our scholarship sponsors who are giving our students an opportunity they wouldn't otherwise be able to afford. We are still looking for one sponsor, so if you feel it would be something you can offer, it costs £25 per month. Contact Lorraine at lorraine.mole@africanvision.org.uk for further details and profile.

## 'HER EDUCATION MATTERS' IS GOING FROM STRENGTH TO STRENGTH!

Fane Layimosi and Esimy Chilinda have now made over 400 washable sanitary pads at Sam's Village. We have distributed 71 'girls packs' to M'teza Primary School to girls in Standards 4—8. Each pack is in a bag which can be used for school. Inside there are 3 pairs of pants, 3 washable pads and a bar of soap. Attendance levels for M'teza have increased for the girls since getting their packs.



*A group of girls with their packs*

Now Fane and Esimy have trained up two other women from Namanyanga Mothers Groups in how to make the pads. We are supplying 2 sewing machines to Namanyanga, where they can also start to make the pads. Every 5th pad the ladies keep and they are able to sell or give to friends and family. We have just started building washrooms at both M'teza and Namanyanga.

Our thanks go to *'Think Malawi'* who are funding this project, *Lytham Sixth Form College* who donated lots of bags for the packs to go into and *Rotary Club Kingston upon Thames* who have provided a £4,000 grant to extend this project further. We are on the look out for drawstring bags, microfibres and old umbrella fabric. If you can help with any of these items, they are gratefully received. It is difficult to get fabrics out, so we are trying to source these in Malawi.

## VOLUNTEERS

In October we had Megan Garner and Joely Stevens join us in Malawi to help paint a mural on our River Block (right) Megan has now been to Malawi a few times and we always value her support! Thanks to both of you.

Cecilia Aguilar has been volunteering at Sam's Village as an intern, helping with Monitoring and Evaluation as well as permaculture. She arrived in August and will be with us until January. She has been a great help in sourcing the success stories of recent graduates, such as Charity and Wesley's on page 1.



*Cecilia Aguilar, our M&E Volunteer*




*The mural on River/Mtsinje accommodation block at Sam's Village*

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***PROJECT4AFRICA***
***OUR MALAWI TEAM***
***ALL SUPPORTERS***
***500 MILES***
***ALL SAINTS KNITTERS***
***TRUSTEES***
***ST MATTHEW'S CHURCH***
***EILEEN SPEAK***
***GAYNOR COOK***
***PARTNERSHIP SCHOOLS***
***AHU GURAY***
***THINK MALAWI***



Winter 2019

## CLIMATE CHANGE

We are all worried about climate change and this obviously effects everyone around the world. We have done some training with our team to make them more aware of the issues of plastics and deforestation and how they can help. Our guards have been filling plastic bottles with waste plastics and we made a stool (below). All our LBC members are getting 5 tree seedlings at Christmas with their '*Zikomo'* (thank you) pack and we are aiming to plant 3,000 trees in December. In January we welcome William Mtuwa from Mzuzu University who is going to help us become an environmentally-friendly organisation. All volunteers flying to Malawi now must offset their carbon emissions by planting 30 trees.







## FUNDRAISING EVENTS

**Christmas Fish and Quiz night—Saturday December 7th . A great event, with a great Christmas quiz. Fully sold out and helped raise £2000. Many thanks to all who supported. See you again next year!**

**Photographic exhibition—Positive change (Gaynor Cook & Sam Palmer). Exhibition will be on for the month of January at the CornerHOUSE.**



**Gala night January 7th 2020 from 7:00pm. At the cornerHOUSE, Douglas Road, Surbiton.**

**Pedal Power 2020 —we are holding 2 cycle challenges in Malawi in 2020. Over Easter we are holding a 'family challenge' of 250km with safari and lake activities included. At the end of May we are holding another which will include an optional climb up Mount Mulanje and then cycling 500km with safari and day by the lake included. Details on our Homepage**



**To watch the latest cycle film go to** https://vimeo.com/352330947

**Retreat to the farm—throughout June, July and September 2020 there are retreats being held in France with 20% of profits going to African Vision Malawi. If you would like to join one, please go to** www.retreattothefarm.co.uk/

### Past events:



**OM & Bass Yoga and Dance festival was held at the end of July. It was an amazing festival with wonderful people. Highly recommended for July 2020! We raised just over £500 Thanks to the incredible Rach Cox for her enthusiasm and putting us forward as their charity.**



**Shambala Festival in August was a very hot weekend where we did adobe brick demonstrations. We hope to be there again in 2020!**

**Ahu Guray did an amazing pilgrimage walk on the Camino de Santiago in Spain in September and raised an incredible £1,700. Many challenges on the way which included her boots breaking and having to walk in flip-flops!**

**Ladies fun night—in September was a brilliant success! We raised £770 towards girls packs and had a lot of fun too. We were mentioned in Surbiton's local paper, *'the good life'*.**





Girls' night out

Great fun was had by all at a Ladies Night to raise money to help educate girls and young women in Malawi.

The all-women fundraiser in the upstairs room at Langleys restaurant, Ewell Road, supported girls at 27 schools in a large rural area north of the capital Lilongwe.

The £770 raised will build washrooms and supply girls' packs – drawstring bags for school use, but which are equipped with washable sanitary pads (made from duvets and microfibre cloths by women in Malawi), pants, soap and flannels.

"Each girl will now have a pack, so when they have their periods they can still go to school instead of missing two-and-a-half months of education each year," said Heather Palmer, above, CEO of Surbiton-based African Vision Malawi. "We thought of having a ladies fun night because this project is all about girls and about women. We are trying to support girls in Malawi, enabling them to go to school, get a better education, and hopefully go on to get a scholarship, which we also fund. We can change people's lives while we are having fun, and it can actually make a real difference."

More on the Upper Brighton Road charity's inspirational work with orphans, vulnerable adults and communities in Malawi at www.africanvision.org.uk

Bees mean hives!